cadre in the valley, its unit in Doda was only involved in covert surveillance activities. Run by Ghulam Hasan Bhat, an ethnic Kashmiri who lived in the remote Kishtwar area, Al-Fatah's Doda unit generated much of the military intelligence the organisation gathered. It also engineered a dramatic robbery of potassium cyanide from the laboratory of a college in Bhadarwah. The members would use this as a means of suicide in the event that any of Al-Fatah's operatives were captured.

In April 1968, soon after Zahgir was released from jail, he had received a visit from the Plebiscite Front leader, Mirza Afzal Beg. Beg was Abdullah's right-hand man and was the Founder-President of the Plebiscite Front in 1955, which would provide an attractive pool of recruits to promote Pakistan's subversion in the valley. He had also been jailed along with Abdullah in 1953 and was released in 1954. In a seminal treatise called *Report on Pakistani Organised Subversion, Sabotage and Infiltration in Jammu and Kashmir*, Surendra Nath, former Director General of Police, Jammu and Kashmir, bluntly stated that it was a political decision to release Beg from imprisonment to ensure that those close to Abdullah could at least, by proxy, participate in the deliberations of the constituent assembly. In later years, Beg became Abdullah's representative in talks with the Indian Government in 1974, clinching the 1975 accord between Abdullah and Indira Gandhi.

While Beg had expressed his support for Zahgir's activities, there is no available evidence to suggest that Beg knew precisely what these specifically were. However, both of them were united in their struggle to get Jammu and Kashmir to secede from the Indian Union. The relationship was to prove highly beneficial for both of them. Al-Fatah had a major concern—it needed a legitimate political front as a cover. It is surmised that, with a nod from Beg, two senior Al-Fatah members, Abdul Rashid Dar and Mohammad Yousaf Mir, were put in charge of building the YML and the SF. The political situation of the day required that Beg had access to Zahgir's network while Zahgir needed access to Beg's legitimacy. Moreover, after the arrests following the Islamia College robbery and the Nawakadal murder, a charge sheet was filed, and prosecution had been